Ashoka is supposed to have given in honour of the Buddha at Mahabodhi. While this cave does not carry an epigraph, the polished character of the outer chamber and its general architecture leaves little doubt that this too was excavated in the time of Ashoka. The third cave, known as Vishwa Jhopri, is on another outcrop and, like the Sudama cave, carries a donative record of Ashoka. This cave (‘kubha’) was for the Ajivikas and is mentioned as being in the Khalatika mountain, the name by which the Barabar hills were then known.[5]

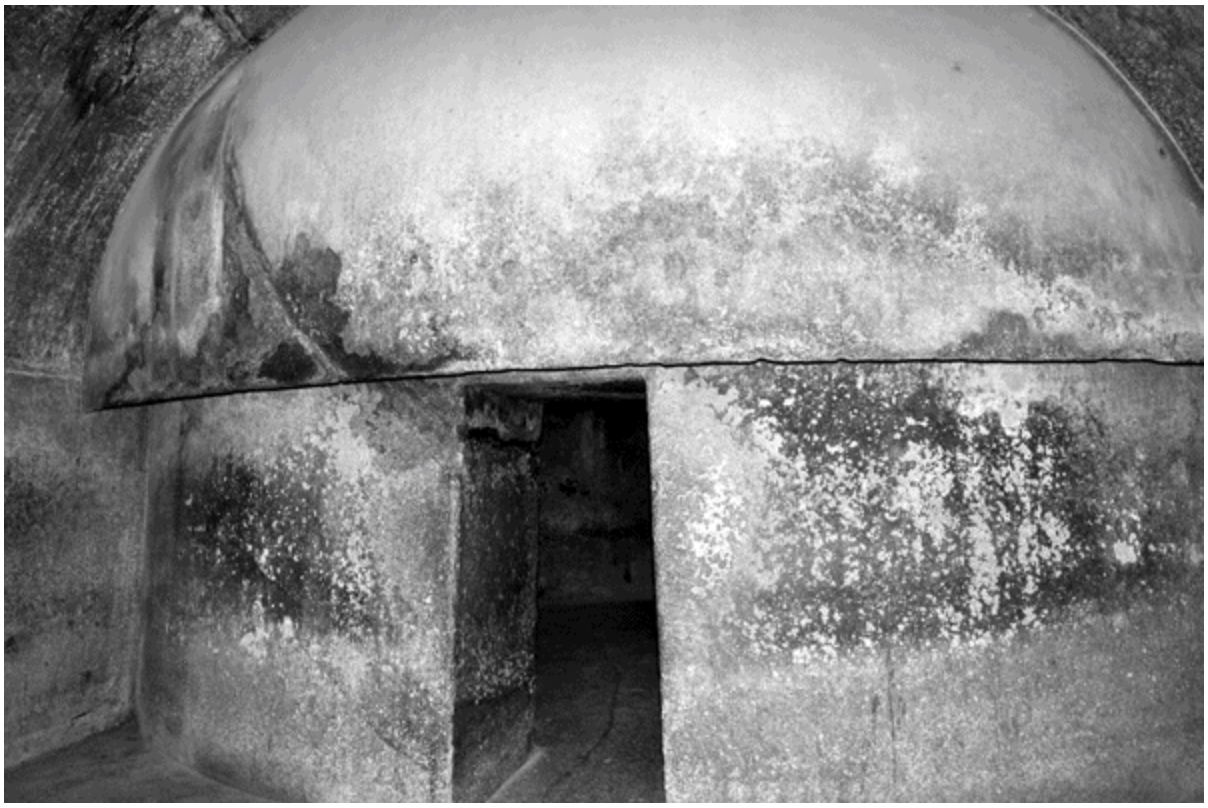


Fig. 10.2: Interior of the Sudama cave with a hut-like structure carved into the rock

The last of Ashoka’s dedications is now known as Karna Chaupar. It was chiselled out of the outcrop within which the Lomasha Rishi and Sudama caves were created. Facing north, it is a one-chamber edifice with a vaulted roof. Polished to a high lustre, it is marked by a low rock-cut platform on the western end. However, this was created seven years after the others, i.e.